



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
Dress Code Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

The appearance of a police officer provides the opportunity for a first impression not just of the individual officer but also of the organization served. Uniforms donned by members of the JCF are intended to and do provide a recognisable source of safety, support and trust. Research suggests that the psychological influence evoked by the presence of a uniformed police officer has a powerful sway on how members of the public perceive the servant of the people who is vested with the powers of the state. The quality standards of an organization are reflected, to a great extent, in the deportment of its members.

As a constantly evolving organization, the JCF has reviewed its guidelines on its dress code to ensure that they are aligned with contemporary policing standards and is committed to its vision to 'become a high-quality professional service that is valued and trusted by all the citizens of Jamaica'. This reviewed Dress Code Policy and Standard Operating Procedures provides the framework on which the organization will ensure that members represent the Jamaica Constabulary Force professionally, consistent with its values and image.

2.0 Purpose

This policy and SOP outlines the JCF's policy on the dress code to be adhered to by members. It provides a standard that should allow for consistency in the deportment of uniformed and non-uniformed members.

3.0 Scope

This Dress Code Policy and Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn members of the JCF and Rural Police Force. It covers the dress code for members on duty, whether in uniform or plain clothes. This policy and SOP does not apply to members engaged in covert/undercover assignments.

4.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy that all members dress professionally and respectfully, reflecting the organization's values and image. Members are required to wear the approved styles/designs, colours, and types of uniforms and be guided by this policy and SOP when attired for work.

5.0 Definition

For this policy and SOP, the following definitions are to be applied:

- 5.1 **Ballistic Vest** - is a type of body armour designed to absorb impact and prevent the penetration of firearm projectiles and explosion fragments to the torso area.
- 5.2 **Cummerbund** - of scarlet material of approved pattern that is worn at the waist.

- 5.3 **Facial Hair** - beard, moustache and sideburns.
- 5.4 **Load-Bearing Vest** – vest-like apparel with multiple compartments used by law enforcement to carry service items that are not easily accommodated on their regular service uniform.
- 5.5 **Members** - all sworn employees within the JCF.
- 5.6 **Professionally Attired** - the wearing of clothing and accessories accepted as appropriate for the workplace.
- 5.7 **Uniform** - standard clothing approved to be worn by members of an organization whilst performing duties.
- 5.8 **Waist Sash** - of scarlet material of approved pattern.

6.0 Abbreviation

CIB	-	Criminal Investigation Branch
JCF	-	Jamaica Constabulary Force
NIB	-	National Intelligence Bureau
PSD	-	Protective Services Division

7.0 Responsibilities

The following summarises the key responsibilities:

- 7.1 **JCF Uniform Committee** is responsible for reviewing the JCF uniform design and make recommendations to the Commissioner of Police.
- 7.2 **The Deputy Commissioner of Police, Administration and Support Services Portfolio** is responsible for providing oversight and support for the compliance of this policy and SOP.
- 7.3 **Area/Branch/Divisional/Formation Commanders** are responsible for:
 - 7.3.1 ensuring that the deployment of members under their command is in strict compliance with this policy and SOP;
 - 7.3.2 ensuring Divisional Stores are sufficiently stocked with uniforms and accoutrements for distribution to members; and
 - 7.3.3 taking appropriate disciplinary actions to deal with breaches.
- 7.4 **The Assistant Commissioner of Police, Training Branch** is to ensure that this policy and SOP is incorporated into all training curricula.

- 7.5 **Superintendent of Police, Headquarters Stores** has the responsibility for:
 - 7.5.1 ensuring that a size role and inventory system is maintained;
 - 7.5.2 ensuring the monitoring and maintenance of stock level;
 - 7.5.3 the distribution of uniform to members and the respective formations; and
 - 7.5.4 causing the requisite returns to be submitted to ACP Support Services Branch in the required timeline.
- 7.6 **Area/Division/Formation Store Managers** are responsible for:
 - 7.6.1 making timely submissions to the Superintendent of Police, Headquarters Stores for uniforms for members; and
 - 7.6.2 ensuring that adequate uniforms are acquired for members under their command.
- 7.7 **Supervisors/Sub-Officers** are to ensure that members:
 - 7.7.1 under their supervision comply with the guidelines set out in this policy and SOP; and
 - 7.7.2 are equipped with the uniform required for duty.
- 7.8 **Members are required to:**
 - 7.8.1 attire themselves for duty in a manner which depicts professionalism and adherence to the standards of the JCF; and
 - 7.8.2 strictly comply with this policy and SOP and maintain the good image and discipline of the organization.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

The following are procedural guidelines and directives to be adhered to by members when performing their duties:

8.1 Ceremonial Dress

Members detailed to perform duties in ceremonial dress are required to be attired as follows:

8.1.1 Gazetted Officers, Inspectors, Sergeants, Corporals and Constables (male and female)

- a. Tunic – White and adorned with the required accoutrements.
- b. Pants and skirts - Navy blue trousers and skirts with red seams.

8.1.2 Waist Sash

- a. **Royal blue with Tassels** - worn by male and female Gazetted Officers.
- b. **Red with Tassels** - worn by male and female Inspectors.

8.1.3 Sash (red) – worn by male and female Sergeants, when required.

8.2 Working Dress & Dress Uniform (Gazetted Officers and Inspectors)

Gazetted Officers and Inspectors may be attired in working dress and dress uniform (Khaki) to perform their respective functions:

- a. **Working Dress** – short-sleeved Tunic (Fawn Terylene) with pants or skirt with required accoutrements.

- b. **Dress Uniform** – long-sleeved Tunic (Fawn Terylene) with pants or skirt, plain white shirt with collar and black tie with required accoutrements.

8.3 JCF Blue Uniform

8.3.1 Members of the JCF (all ranks)

Members detailed to perform duties dressed in blue uniform are required to be attired as follows:

8.3.1.1 Uniform Shirt

- a. Left arm – Jamaican Flag
- b. Right arm – JCF Insignia and “POLICE” badge below
- c. Left front – JCF Insignia above the breast pocket
- d. Right front – Name Badge with the regulation number affixed above
- e. Left and right shoulder – Badge of rank and “JCF” flash; metal for rank and file; metal or embroidered for Gazetted Ranks

NB: Undershirts/blouses are not to be visible if worn.

8.3.1.2 Pants

Pants are to be worn so that the hem falls neatly on top of the shoes' lower eyelets. Pants are not to be too close-fitted to prevent members from performing their duties effectively.

8.4 Rural Police Force (District Constable)

8.4.1 For the performance of duties, District Constables are required to be attired in:

- a. **Sky blue shirt** is required to be worn by both males and females with shoulder flash “D/C” on left and right shoulders and the Rural Police Crest displayed on the left front breast pocket.
- b. **Navy blue pants/skirt** are required to be worn by males/females, respectively

8.5 Operational and Cell Duties

- a. When performing operational and cell duties, members are required to be attired as outlined in sub-sections **8.3.1.1, (a-e) and 8.3.1.2** of this policy and SOP.
- b. Shoulder flashes “D/C” are to be affixed to the epaulettes on the left and right shoulders

8.6 The Wearing of Headdress

Members are required to wear headdresses approved by the Commissioner of Police, based on the recommendation of the JCF Uniform Committee, during their tour of duty. The correct insignias are to be worn on forage and peak caps:

- a. **Peak Cap** – worn by all ranks when attired in working dress, dress uniform and full ceremonial uniforms; other ranks in full ceremonial uniforms.

- b. **Baseball Cap** - worn by all ranks when attired in the navy-blue uniform with the JCF Crest displayed on the front and for Gazetted Ranks in addition braids are on the brim.
 - c. **Ballistic Helmet** - operational and special operational teams (OST, AFAT, etc.).
- 8.7 **Working shoes** – only approved footwear are to be worn in uniform.
- 8.8 **Belt and buckle** – only approved belts and buckles are to be worn in uniform.
- 8.9 **Accoutrements:**
Any other authorized accoutrement may be worn in uniforms, such as medal(s), ribbons, whistle and chain, distinguished badges, buttons, and special pins.
- 8.10 **Tactical and Protective Gears**
 - 8.10.1 **Ballistic Vest** - Members may wear approved ballistic vests. The word ‘POLICE’ is to be displayed on the back of the vest, and their regulation number is required to be affixed to the front.
 - 8.10.2 **Load-Bearing Vest** - Members engaged in operational duties may wear a load-bearing vest. The vest must be worn with the member's identity displayed.
- 8.11 **Specialist Divisions/Formations**
Members assigned to specialist divisions and formations, such as Canine, Telecommunication Division, Headquarters Stores, Marine, etc., are required to wear uniforms approved by the Commissioner of Police based on the recommendation of the JCF Uniform Committee.

NB: Where uniform requires alteration, this is to be done without interrupting the approved style/design.
- 8.12 **Members detailed to perform duties in plain clothes**
Members who are assigned duties in plain clothes, such as CIB, PSD, and NIB, are required to be attired professionally:
 - 8.12.1 **Females** – are required to be professionally attired in business suits or corporate wear. Low-cut or tight-fitting blouses, miniskirts, short dresses, tight-fitting skirts or pants that are likely to diminish the professional decorum of the JCF are prohibited.

8.12.2 **Males** – should be professionally attired in business suits or corporate wear. Blazers or jackets are mandatory for court appearances.

8.12.3 **Wearing of CIB Vest** - where required, members assigned plain clothes duties may be required to wear a CIB Vest. The vest is to be in the JCF Uniform Committee's approved design and bear the member's computer or regulation number.

8.13 **Hairstyle for females**

Hairstyles are to be neatly groomed in a professional manner suitable for work. The following procedures are to be adhered to:

8.13.1 hair should not pass the nape (the back of the neck), allowing both ears to be visible;

8.13.2 hair made in a bun are to be neatly tied to the back and of a moderate size;

8.13.3 hairstyle should not be of excessive volume (bulky) and is to be kept out of the face;

8.13.4 overly elaborate hairstyles should not be worn;

8.13.5 the colour of the hairstyles worn should be of a low tone that creates a natural-looking effect; and

8.13.6 black or blue hair ornaments, such as scrunchies are allowed to harness the hair and should be covered by the hair.

8.14 **Hairstyles for males** – males should ensure that their hair is neatly trimmed at all times. Hair should be of a natural colour and texture.

8.15 **Wearing of facial hair**

8.15.1 Males are allowed to wear neatly trimmed facial hair whilst performing their duties.

8.15.2 Facial hair is required to be well-groomed in the natural colour and texture of the member's hair.

8.16 **Wearing of jewellery and accessories**

8.16.1 **Members in uniform**

a. The wearing of jewellery and accessories are required to be such that it should not compromise the professional appearance of the uniform.

b. Members may wear their wedding ring/band, one other ring, and a wristwatch in their uniform.

- c. Females are allowed to wear one pair of knob earrings while dressed in uniform. The knob is **NOT** to be larger than **0.16 inches or 4mm** in diameter and may be silver or gold.
- d. Jewellery or accessories are not to be displayed whilst in uniform, and include:-
 - i. necklace/chains
 - ii. bracelets
 - iii. anklets
 - iv. nose, eyebrow or lip ring/knob in any visible parts of the body
 - v. tattoos

8.16.2 **Members dress in plain clothes**

Members in plain clothes may wear the following whilst performing their duties:

- a. wedding ring/band along with one other ring
- b. necklace/chain
- c. bracelet
- d. wristwatch
- e. earrings – as mentioned at **section 8.16.1 (c)**.

8.17 **General Appearance**

The following may be worn whilst performing duties:

8.17.1 **Lip gloss/Lip balm** may be worn but should be transparent and without sparkles whilst in uniform. Female members in plain clothes may wear coloured lipsticks that are suitable for the working environment.

8.17.2 **Fingernails:**

- a. Nails are to be worn at a short length, which should not prevent the members from performing their duties effectively.
- b. No extreme designs/styles are to be displayed on fingernails. Claw-like, stiletto or overly decorative nails are not to be worn.
- c. Colours are required to be muted and subdued to complement the uniform, such as clear, beige, or pale pink. Bold, bright, or neon colours are not permitted.

8.17.3 **Artificial Eyelashes** – artificial eyelashes should **NOT** be worn while performing duties.

9.0 **Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles**

This JCF Dress Code Policy and SOP is to be read in conjunction with:

- 9.1 The Book of Rules for the Guidance and General Direction of the Jamaica Constabulary Force.
- 9.2 Jamaica Constabulary Force Orders No. 4006 dated 14th March, 2024.